

40 prompts — from idea to launch in 90 days

40

PROMPTS

PDF

FORMAT

4 AI

COMPATIBLE

\$34

USD

Business Strategy

Works with: **ChatGPT** • **Claude** • **Gemini** • **Llama**

About This Playbook

Everything a founder needs to go from idea to validated, funded, and launched. 40 prompts covering market research, business planning, financial modeling, go-to-market, and investor relations.

What You'll Get

- 40 expert prompts • Professional-grade frameworks • Placeholder system for instant use • Expert tips on every prompt

Who It's For

- Entrepreneurs • Professionals • Consultants • Teams

How to Use This Playbook

- 1 Copy the prompt — Select the full prompt text from the section that matches your goal.
- 2 Fill in the brackets — Replace all [PLACEHOLDER] text with your specific context, brand, or product.
- 3 Paste & generate — Paste into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or your preferred AI tool.
- 4 Iterate — Use the output as a starting point. Refine with follow-up prompts for best results.

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Section 1

Market Research & Validation (8 prompts)

Prompt #01

Problem Validation Framework

Validate whether [PROBLEM] is worth building a business around using p

You are a startup mentor who has helped 200+ founders validate ideas. Validate whether [PROBLEM] is worth building a business around using primary and secondary research methods. Deliver: 1. 5 customer discovery questions to ask in interviews 2. Survey template (10 questions) 3. TAM/SAM/SOM calculation framework 4. Competitor landscape mapping template 5. Problem severity scoring rubric 6. Go/no-go decision criteria

Placeholders: [PROBLEM] The problem you think you're solving

■ **Tip:** The #1 startup killer is building something nobody wants. Spend 4 weeks validating before writing a line of code.

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Gemini ✓

Prompt #02

Customer Interview Script

Create a complete customer interview script for validating [PRODUCT ID

You are a lean startup practitioner. Create a complete customer interview script for validating [PRODUCT IDEA] with [TARGET CUSTOMER]. Deliver: 15-question interview guide: 1. Opening questions (build rapport, understand context) 2. Problem exploration (how do they experience the problem today?) 3. Current solution audit (what are they using now?) 4. Ideal solution probing (without pitching) 5. Willingness-to-pay signals 6. Closing and referrals Include: Active listening prompts, red/green flags to listen for, notes template

Placeholders: [PRODUCT IDEA] Your concept [TARGET CUSTOMER] Who you're interviewing

■ **Tip:** Never pitch during a discovery interview. Your job is to listen and learn — not to sell. Ask 'tell me more' 10 times.

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Gemini ✓

Prompt #03

Competitor Analysis Template

Create a comprehensive competitor analysis for [YOUR PRODUCT] in the [

You are a competitive intelligence analyst. Create a comprehensive competitor analysis for [YOUR PRODUCT] in the [MARKET] space. Deliver: 1. Competitor identification (direct, indirect, and substitute) 2. Feature comparison matrix 3. Pricing model comparison 4. Positioning and messaging analysis 5. Customer sentiment analysis (review mining framework) 6. Distribution channel comparison 7. Your competitive advantage matrix 8. White space opportunity identification

Placeholders: [YOUR PRODUCT] What you're building [MARKET] Your target market

■ **Tip:** The best competitive advantage often isn't features — it's distribution, brand, or business model. Look at all three.

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Prompt #04

Market Sizing — TAM/SAM/SOM

Calculate the addressable market for [PRODUCT] using top-down and bott

You are a market research analyst. Calculate the addressable market for [PRODUCT] using top-down and bottom-up methodologies. Deliver: Top-down method: 1. Total addressable market (TAM) — global/national market size 2. Serviceable addressable market (SAM) — segment you can reach 3. Serviceable obtainable market (SOM) — realistic 3-year capture Bottom-up method: 1. Target customer count × average revenue per customer 2. Year 1/2/3 projections Sources to verify each number + assumptions to document

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Be honest about your SOM. Investors know your TAM. What they care about is your path to capturing the first 1%.

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Prompt #05

Lean Validation Experiment Design

Design 3 lean experiments to test [ASSUMPTION] before building [FEATUR

You are a lean startup coach. Design 3 lean experiments to test [ASSUMPTION] before building [FEATURE/PRODUCT]. Deliver: For each experiment: 1. Hypothesis statement: 'We believe [X] will lead to [Y] for [Z] customers' 2. Minimum viable test: The simplest way to test this 3. Success metric: What data confirms or denies the hypothesis 4. Time limit: Max X days/weeks for this experiment 5. Cost: Max \$X to run 6. What you'll do with each outcome (build/pivot/stop)

Placeholders: [ASSUMPTION] The belief you're testing [FEATURE/PRODUCT] What you're considering building

■ **Tip:** The cheapest experiments use landing pages, mockups, and Wizard of Oz testing. Never build to validate — validate to decide if you build.

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Prompt #06

Customer Persona — Deep Profile

Build 3 detailed customer personas for [PRODUCT] based on [CUSTOMER RE

You are a user research specialist. Build 3 detailed customer personas for [PRODUCT] based on [CUSTOMER RESEARCH/HYPOTHESIS]. Deliver: For each persona: • Demographics (age, role, company size, income) • Goals (what are they trying to achieve?) • Frustrations (what's stopping them?) • Day in the life (how do they currently spend their time?) • Watering holes (where do they find information?) • Buying triggers (what makes them buy?) • Decision blockers (what stops them?) • Quote that captures their worldview

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product [CUSTOMER RESEARCH/HYPOTHESIS] Research data or assumptions

■ **Tip:** Personas are only useful if they're specific enough to make a decision. 'Marketing managers' is too broad. 'B2B SaaS marketing managers at 50-200 person companies' is useful.

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Gemini ✓

Prompt #07

Pricing Research — Willingness to Pay

Determine the optimal price for [PRODUCT] using the Van Westendorp and

You are a pricing strategist. Determine the optimal price for [PRODUCT] using the Van Westendorp and Gabor-Granger frameworks. Deliver: Van Westendorp Price Sensitivity Meter: 4 survey questions + how to interpret the results
Gabor-Granger direct pricing test: Question format + analysis framework
Competitor price benchmarking template Value-based pricing calculation: How to quantify the ROI your product delivers Pricing recommendation format + how to A/B test

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Charge more than you're comfortable with. Most founders underprice by 40-60%. Price at discomfort — that's usually market rate.

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Prompt #08

Demand Validation — Waitlist Strategy

Design a pre-launch waitlist campaign to validate demand for [PRODUCT]

You are a growth marketer. Design a pre-launch waitlist campaign to validate demand for [PRODUCT] before launch. Deliver: 1. Landing page structure (headline, proof, CTA) 2. Email capture form and confirmation message 3. Referral loop (how to get waitlist members to share) 4. Email sequence to waitlist (3 emails to keep them warm) 5. Success metrics (what numbers prove real demand) 6. How to convert waitlist to paying customers on launch

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** 10,000 waitlist signups with 0 paying customers is not validation. Validation is someone giving you money or a signed LOI.

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Section 2

Business Planning (8 prompts)

Prompt #09

Business Model Canvas

Complete a Business Model Canvas for [STARTUP IDEA].

You are a startup strategy consultant. Complete a Business Model Canvas for [STARTUP IDEA]. Deliver: Fill all 9 blocks with specific, actionable content: 1. Value Propositions: What problem you solve and for whom 2. Customer Segments: Who your most important customers are 3. Channels: How you reach and deliver to customers 4. Customer Relationships: Type of relationship you establish 5. Revenue Streams: How you make money (pricing model) 6. Key Resources: What you absolutely must have 7. Key Activities: What you must do well 8. Key Partners: Who you can't succeed without 9. Cost Structure: Most important costs + One-page narrative connecting all 9 blocks

Placeholders: [STARTUP IDEA] Your business concept

■ **Tip:** The BMC is a hypothesis document, not a plan. Treat each block as an assumption to test, not a fact.

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Prompt #10

Revenue Model Design

Design 3 alternative revenue models for [PRODUCT] with pros, cons, and

You are a startup finance specialist. Design 3 alternative revenue models for [PRODUCT] with pros, cons, and recommendation. Deliver: Model options to evaluate: 1. Subscription (monthly/annual) – recurring predictable revenue 2. Usage-based / metered – aligned with customer value 3. Freemium – large top of funnel with conversion focus 4. One-time + upsell – lower friction entry 5. Marketplace/take rate – requires network effects 6. Service/consulting hybrid – funded by services, scaled by software For each: Revenue potential, margin profile, customer acquisition cost impact, when to use it

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** The business model is often more defensible than the product. Choose the model that creates the best customer outcomes.

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Prompt #11

Go-to-Market Strategy Framework

Create a go-to-market strategy for [PRODUCT] targeting [ICP] in [MARKET]

You are a GTM strategy consultant. Create a go-to-market strategy for [PRODUCT] targeting [ICP] in [MARKET]. Deliver: 1. ICP definition (firmographics + psychographics + trigger events) 2. Channel selection: Where to find them + acquisition cost estimate per channel 3. Positioning statement: How you're different from alternatives 4. Messaging framework: For each stage of awareness 5. Sales motion: Product-led, sales-led, or hybrid – and why 6. First 100 customers plan: Specific tactics for early traction 7. CAC target and payback period 8. Month 1/3/6/12 milestones

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product [ICP] Ideal customer profile [MARKET] Your target market

■ **Tip:** Your GTM for your first 100 customers should look nothing like your GTM for 10,000. Manual and unscalable is fine to start.

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Prompt #12

Unit Economics Model

Model the unit economics for [BUSINESS] with path to profitability.

You are a startup CFO. Model the unit economics for [BUSINESS] with path to profitability. Deliver: Key metrics to calculate: • Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) – by channel • Customer Lifetime Value (LTV) – by segment • LTV:CAC ratio and target • Payback period • Gross margin by product line • Monthly burn rate • Runway at current burn Break-even analysis: • Fixed costs vs. variable costs • Revenue needed for break-even • Months to break-even at current growth rate Sensitivity table: What happens if churn increases by 2%?

Placeholders: [BUSINESS] Your business model

■ **Tip:** LTV:CAC ratio below 3:1 is a warning sign. Below 1:1 is a crisis. Know these numbers before raising.

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Prompt #13

Company Values and Culture Code

Write a company values document and culture code for [STARTUP].

You are a culture-first founder. Write a company values document and culture code for [STARTUP]. Deliver: 1. Mission statement (what you do and why it matters) 2. Vision statement (what the world looks like if you win) 3. Core values (3-5 values with behavioral definitions) 4. Culture principles (how decisions get made) 5. What we're not (as important as what you are) 6. How we hire (the non-negotiables) 7. How we fire (what violations look like) 8. Communication norms

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your company name and space

■ **Tip:** Culture is hiring. Every value must have a clear behavioral example of what it looks like in practice — and what violates it.

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Prompt #14

OKR Framework — First Year

Set the first-year OKRs for [STARTUP] across product, growth, and oper

You are a startup operations coach. Set the first-year OKRs for [STARTUP] across product, growth, and operations. Deliver: Q1 OKRs: Focus on validation and foundation Q2 OKRs: Focus on first traction and product-market fit signals Q3 OKRs: Focus on repeatable growth and efficiency Q4 OKRs: Focus on scale preparation and funding readiness For each OKR: • Objective (qualitative, inspirational) • 3-5 Key Results (quantitative, measurable) • Owner • Weekly check-in format

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** OKRs only work when they're uncomfortable. If you're 100% confident you'll hit them, they're not ambitious enough.

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Prompt #15

Strategic Partnership Strategy

Identify and create an outreach strategy for [STARTUP]'s top 10 strate

You are a business development specialist. Identify and create an outreach strategy for [STARTUP]'s top 10 strategic partnership targets. Deliver: Partnership types to consider: • Distribution partnerships (reach their customers) • Technology partnerships (integrate with their product) • Channel partnerships (they resell or refer you) • Co-marketing partnerships (shared audiences) For each partnership type: • Target partner profile • Value exchange (what you each get) • Outreach approach • Partnership agreement outline • Success metrics

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** The best early partnerships are with companies whose customers are your customers — but you're not competing for the same budget.

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Prompt #16

Lean Operations Playbook

Create a lean operations playbook for a [STAGE] startup with [HEADCOUN

You are a startup operations specialist. Create a lean operations playbook for a [STAGE] startup with [HEADCOUNT] people. Deliver: 1. Decision-making framework (who decides what, at what cost threshold) 2. Meeting rhythm (daily/weekly/monthly cadence) 3. Communication stack (tools and norms for each channel) 4. Hiring process (how to hire the first 10 people fast and well) 5. Onboarding template (what a new hire does in week 1) 6. Core KPI dashboard (the 5-10 metrics everyone sees weekly) 7. Vendor and tool evaluation criteria

Placeholders: [STAGE] Pre-seed/seed/Series A [HEADCOUNT] Current team size

■ **Tip:** The best startup ops are boring — clear, consistent, documented. Chaos is a startup excuse, not a culture.

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Section 3

Financial Modeling (8 prompts)

Prompt #17

3-Year Financial Model

Build a 3-year financial model for [STARTUP] in [BUSINESS MODEL].

You are a startup CFO and financial modeler. Build a 3-year financial model for [STARTUP] in [BUSINESS MODEL]. Deliver: Revenue model: • Month-by-month Year 1, quarterly Years 2-3 • Revenue drivers (users, contracts, ARPU) • Churn and growth assumptions Cost model: • COGS and gross margin • Headcount plan and fully-loaded salaries • Operating expenses by category Cash flow: • Monthly burn rate • Runway at each funding scenario Key outputs: P&L, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow statement Assumptions tab: Document every assumption

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [BUSINESS MODEL] SaaS/marketplace/e-commerce/etc

■ **Tip:** Your model is only as good as your assumptions. Document every assumption — it shows investors you understand your business.

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Prompt #18

Fundraising Model — How Much to Raise

Determine how much [STARTUP] should raise and at what valuation.

You are a venture-backed startup advisor. Determine how much [STARTUP] should raise and at what valuation. Deliver: Framework: 1. Define milestone: What do you need to prove to raise your next round? 2. Calculate cost: What does it cost to reach that milestone? 3. Add buffer: Multiply by 1.5x for delays and surprises 4. Runway target: 18-24 months minimum 5. Dilution check: How much equity are you giving up at target valuation? 6. Valuation benchmarks: Comparable company valuations at this stage 7. Term sheet basics: What to expect in each key term

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** Raise enough to reach your next milestone with 6 months of buffer. Running out of runway 3 months before your next milestone is the most preventable startup death.

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Prompt #19

Investor Update Template — Monthly

Write a monthly investor update template for [STARTUP] that builds trust

You are a VC-backed founder. Write a monthly investor update template for [STARTUP] that builds trust and prompts help. Deliver: Structure: 1. Headline (one number that captures the month – up or down, honest) 2. Key metrics (5-7 core KPIs vs last month and vs plan) 3. Top wins (2-3 – specific, not general) 4. Challenges (2-3 – honest, show your thinking on solutions) 5. What we need (specific asks – intros, advice, resources) 6. Focus next month (3 priorities) Also write: The tone guidance (what investors want vs what founders want to say)

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** 'What we need' is the most important section. Investors want to help — but you must ask specifically. 'Introductions to Fortune 500 CTOs in healthcare' gets results. 'Help with sales' doesn't.

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Prompt #20

Cap Table Management Guide

Explain cap table management for [STARTUP] from founding through Serie

You are a startup legal and finance advisor. Explain cap table management for [STARTUP] from founding through Series A. Deliver: 1. Founding shares: How to split among co-founders 2. Option pool: How much to reserve, when to create it 3. SAFE notes: How they work and convert 4. Priced rounds: Pre-money vs post-money, pro-rata rights 5. Dilution calculator: How to model dilution across rounds 6. Red flags to avoid: Common cap table mistakes 7. Investor rights: What's standard vs what to negotiate

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your company

■ **Tip:** Cap table mistakes at founding are the most expensive and hardest to fix. Get a lawyer for your first round even if it costs \$5K.

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Prompt #21

Revenue Forecasting — Bottom-Up Method

Build a bottom-up revenue forecast for [STARTUP] for the next 12 month

You are a revenue operations specialist. Build a bottom-up revenue forecast for [STARTUP] for the next 12 months. Deliver: Build from first principles: 1. Sales capacity (how many reps, how many deals/rep/month) 2. Conversion rates (leads → qualified → closed) 3. Deal size assumptions by segment 4. Ramp time for new reps 5. Churn rate impact on recurring revenue 6. Expansion revenue modeling (upsell/cross-sell) Output: Month-by-month ARR forecast with assumptions for each driver

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** Bottom-up forecasts are more credible to investors than top-down ('if we get 1% of a \$1B market'). They show you understand your sales process.

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Prompt #22

Burn Rate and Cash Management

Build a burn rate and cash management framework for [STARTUP] with \$[A

You are a startup finance advisor. Build a burn rate and cash management framework for [STARTUP] with \$[AMOUNT] in the bank. Deliver: 1. Fixed costs audit: What you're committed to spending regardless of revenue 2. Variable costs: What scales with growth vs what can be cut 3. Burn rate scenarios: Conservative/base/optimistic 4. Runway calculation: Months at each burn scenario 5. Cash preservation levers: What to cut first if revenue misses 6. Fundraising trigger: When to start the next raise (9 months runway) 7. Investor communication: How to communicate a burn problem

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [AMOUNT] Cash in bank

■ **Tip:** Start your next fundraise at 12 months of runway. At 6 months you're fundraising from weakness. At 3 months you're desperate.

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Prompt #23

SaaS Metrics Deep Dive

Calculate and interpret the critical SaaS metrics for [SAAS STARTUP] u

You are a SaaS financial analyst. Calculate and interpret the critical SaaS metrics for [SAAS STARTUP] using this period's data. Deliver: Metrics to calculate and interpret: 1. MRR / ARR and growth rate 2. Net Revenue Retention (NRR / NDR) 3. Gross Revenue Retention (GRR) 4. CAC and CAC payback period 5. LTV and LTV:CAC ratio 6. Churn rate (logo and revenue) 7. Magic Number / Sales Efficiency 8. Rule of 40 calculation For each: Formula + what good looks like + what your number means

Placeholders: [SAAS STARTUP] Your SaaS company

■ **Tip:** NRR above 120% means you can grow even with zero new customers. This is the single most important SaaS metric after product-market fit.

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Prompt #24

Exit Strategy and M&A; Positioning

Plan the exit strategy for [STARTUP] including potential acquirers and

You are a startup exit advisor. Plan the exit strategy for [STARTUP] including potential acquirers and positioning. Deliver: 1. Exit scenario analysis: IPO / strategic acquisition / financial buyout 2. Potential strategic acquirers: Top 10 companies who'd want to buy you (and why) 3. Value drivers: What makes you acquirable (technology, customers, team, data) 4. EBITDA / Revenue multiples for your category 5. Build-vs-buy analysis from acquirer's perspective 6. Timeline to optimal exit positioning 7. Pre-exit checklist: What to have in order before M&A process

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** Build your company to last, but position it to be acquired. The two strategies aren't in conflict — great companies get acquired.

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Section 4

Go-to-Market Strategy (8 prompts)

Prompt #25

Product-Led Growth Strategy

Design a product-led growth strategy for [PRODUCT] that drives acquisition

You are a PLG specialist. Design a product-led growth strategy for [PRODUCT] that drives acquisition through product usage. Deliver: 1. PLG motion: Freemium / free trial / usage-based (choose and justify) 2. Activation milestone: The one action that predicts long-term retention 3. 'Aha moment' design: How to get users to their first value in under 10 minutes 4. Viral loops: How product usage drives new user acquisition 5. Upgrade triggers: What in-product moments prompt conversion 6. Expansion revenue: How usage growth drives revenue growth 7. PLG metrics: The 5 numbers to track

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** The activation milestone is the most important thing you'll ever design. Everything before it is acquisition cost; everything after it is LTV.

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Prompt #26

Content Marketing Strategy

Build a 6-month content marketing strategy for [STARTUP] targeting [ICP]

You are a B2B content marketing strategist. Build a 6-month content marketing strategy for [STARTUP] targeting [ICP]. Deliver: Month 1-2: Foundation • SEO keyword research framework • Content pillar selection (3 pillars that own your space) • Distribution channels + publishing cadence Month 3-4: Traction • Long-form content types that generate backlinks • Guest posting strategy • Content repurposing system Month 5-6: Conversion • Bottom-of-funnel content (comparison, use case, ROI calculators) • Content conversion optimization • Pipeline attribution framework

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [ICP] Ideal customer profile

■ **Tip:** Bottom-of-funnel content (comparison pages, use case pages) generates 5x more qualified pipeline than top-of-funnel. Build both.

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Prompt #27

Community-Led Growth Strategy

Design a community-led growth strategy for [STARTUP] that makes custom

You are a community building specialist. Design a community-led growth strategy for [STARTUP] that makes customers your best channel. Deliver: 1. Community purpose: Why would your customers gather even without you? 2. Platform selection: Slack/Discord/Circle/LinkedIn/in-product – with rationale 3. Initial seeding: How to get the first 100 members (the hardest part) 4. Content rhythm: What happens every week to keep the community alive 5. Member journey: Lurker → contributor → leader pipeline 6. Community-to-product flywheel: How community insights improve your product 7. Metrics: How you measure community health vs vanity

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** *Communities fail because founders build them for marketing, not for members. Build it for them and the marketing happens naturally.*

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Prompt #28

Partnership and Integration Strategy

Map and prioritize the top 10 technology partnerships for [STARTUP] to

You are a business development director. Map and prioritize the top 10 technology partnerships for [STARTUP] to accelerate growth. Deliver: For each partnership: 1. Partner name and why they're strategic 2. What their customers need that you provide 3. Integration depth required (lightweight vs deep) 4. Revenue potential (co-sell, marketplace listing, referral) 5. Mutual value exchange 6. Outreach approach and key contact 7. Timeline to first integration live

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** *The best technology partnerships start with a customer asking 'do you integrate with X?' Answer that question by counting how many times you hear it.*

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Prompt #29

Influencer and Thought Leader Strategy

Create an influencer and thought leader partnership strategy for [STAR

You are a B2B influencer marketing specialist. Create an influencer and thought leader partnership strategy for [STARTUP] in [MARKET]. Deliver: Tier 1 – Mega thought leaders (50K+ followers in your niche): Approach: Co-created content, not sponsorship Tier 2 – Rising voices (5K-50K, high engagement): Approach: Advisory board, early access, revenue share Tier 3 – Customer advocates (any size, authentic users): Approach: Case studies, testimonials, referral incentives For each tier: Outreach template + value exchange + success metrics

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [MARKET] Your target market

■ **Tip:** Your best influencers are your happiest customers. Find the ones with audiences before you spend money on external influencers.

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Prompt #30

Launch Event and PR Strategy

Plan the launch strategy for [STARTUP] across media, community, and ev

You are a startup PR consultant. Plan the launch strategy for [STARTUP] across media, community, and events. Deliver: Launch assets to create: 1. Press release (for journalists) 2. Product Hunt launch strategy (for indie hackers and early adopters) 3. LinkedIn launch post (for professional network) 4. Email announcement to waitlist (for subscribers) 5. Partner announcement cascade (for ecosystem) 6. Community posts (Slack/Discord/Reddit for your niche) For each channel: Asset copy + timing + target metric

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** Coordinate all channels to launch on the same day. Synchronized launches create the perception of momentum. Staggered launches create noise.

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Prompt #31

Paid Acquisition Strategy — First \$10K

Allocate the first \$10,000 in paid acquisition spend for [STARTUP] across channels

You are a growth marketing specialist. Allocate the first \$10,000 in paid acquisition spend for [STARTUP] across channels. Deliver: Budget allocation recommendation + rationale For each channel you recommend: • Why this channel for this product/ICP • Targeting approach • Creative strategy • Bid strategy • Success metrics • When to scale vs kill Testing framework: How to allocate test budget vs scale budget CAC target by channel and how to calculate it

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** Spend the first \$10K on learning, not scaling. Every dollar should answer a question about which channel and message works.

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Prompt #32

Expansion Revenue Playbook

Design an expansion revenue playbook for [STARTUP] to grow revenue from existing customers

You are a customer success and expansion specialist. Design an expansion revenue playbook for [STARTUP] to grow revenue from existing customers. Deliver: Expansion motions: 1. Upsell: Higher tier, more features, more users 2. Cross-sell: Adjacent products or modules 3. Seat expansion: Add licenses as team grows 4. Usage expansion: Volume-based billing growth For each motion: • Trigger event (when to make the expansion ask) • Who makes the ask (CSM, AE, or product-led) • The offer (how to frame it) • Playbook (3-step expansion sequence) Metrics: NRR, expansion MRR, logo vs revenue retention

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** Expansion revenue has zero CAC. A 10% improvement in NRR is worth more than a 10% improvement in new logo growth.

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Section 5

Investor Relations (8 prompts)

Prompt #33

Pitch Deck Outline — 10 Slides

Write a complete 10-slide pitch deck outline for [STARTUP] raising [AMOUNT]

You are a venture capital investor. Write a complete 10-slide pitch deck outline for [STARTUP] raising [AMOUNT]. Deliver: Slide-by-slide content guide: 1. Cover: Company name, tagline, ask 2. Problem: The specific, quantified problem 3. Solution: Your product and the mechanism 4. Market: TAM/SAM/SOM with credible sources 5. Business model: How you make money 6. Traction: The most impressive proof you have 7. Team: Why you're the team to win this 8. Competition: Honest competitive positioning 9. Financials: 3-year forecast + key assumptions 10. Ask: How much, for what milestones For each slide: What to include + what to avoid + common mistakes

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [AMOUNT] Fundraising amount

■ **Tip:** Your traction slide wins or loses the meeting. Even 10 paying customers beats 10,000 waitlist signups.

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Prompt #34

Cold Investor Email Outreach

Write a cold investor outreach email system for [STARTUP] targeting [INVESTOR TYPE]

You are a venture-backed founder and fundraising coach. Write a cold investor outreach email system for [STARTUP] targeting [INVESTOR TYPE]. Deliver: Part 1 – The cold email: • Subject line (2 options: data-led and story-led) • Body (under 150 words): Problem you solve + traction signal + ask • Intro ask (specific, low-commitment) Part 2 – The follow-up sequence: • FU1 (Day 5): New traction update • FU2 (Day 10): Mutual connection angle or new press • FU3 (Day 21): Closing the loop Part 3 – Warm introduction request: • Template for asking a mutual to make an intro • How to 'double opt-in' the introduction

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [INVESTOR TYPE] Seed/Series A VC or angel

■ **Tip:** Warm introductions convert to meetings at 40%+. Cold emails at 2-5%. Spend 80% of your fundraising time generating warm intros.

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Prompt #35

Investor Q&A; Preparation

Prepare answers to the 20 hardest investor questions for [STARTUP].

You are a startup investor and fundraising coach. Prepare answers to the 20 hardest investor questions for [STARTUP]. Deliver: Questions to prepare for: 1. Why you? Why this team? 2. What's your moat? 3. Why hasn't this been done before? 4. What happens if Google/Amazon builds this? 5. What's your CAC and LTV? 6. Why is now the right time? 7. What does the \$5M milestone look like? 8. Who are your references (customers/investors)? 9. What keeps you up at night? 10. What's your 5-year vision? 11-20: [Industry-specific hard questions] For each: The answer framework + what not to say

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** The hardest investor questions are gifts. They reveal the risks investors see in your business — which are also your biggest risks.

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Prompt #36

Term Sheet Negotiation Guide

Explain the key terms in a [STAGE] term sheet and what to negotiate.

You are a startup lawyer and VC veteran. Explain the key terms in a [STAGE] term sheet and what to negotiate. Deliver: Core terms to understand: 1. Valuation (pre vs post-money) 2. Option pool shuffle (how it affects your dilution) 3. Liquidation preferences (1x vs 2x, participating vs non-participating) 4. Anti-dilution provisions 5. Pro-rata rights 6. Board composition 7. Information rights 8. Drag-along and tag-along rights For each term: What it means in plain language + what's market standard + what to push back on

Placeholders: [STAGE] Pre-seed/seed/Series A

■ **Tip:** Negotiating the wrong terms early can cost you millions at exit. Liquidation preference and board seats matter most.

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Prompt #37

Due Diligence Preparation

Prepare [STARTUP] for investor due diligence with a complete data room

You are a startup CFO and investor. Prepare [STARTUP] for investor due diligence with a complete data room checklist. Deliver: Organize by category: Legal: Cap table, incorporation docs, IP assignments, customer contracts Financial: Historical financials, projections, bank statements, MRR dashboard Product: Technical architecture, security practices, roadmap Growth: Marketing metrics, CAC by channel, cohort analysis Team: Org chart, employment agreements, equity grants, key person risk Customers: NPS data, churn analysis, reference customers list For each document: What it is + why investors want it + red flags to address proactively

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** A complete data room signals institutional maturity. A missing data room creates doubt. Prepare it before you need it.

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Prompt #38

Board Meeting Preparation

Write a board meeting agenda and preparation guide for [STARTUP]'s [STAGE]

You are a board member and startup advisor. Write a board meeting agenda and preparation guide for [STARTUP]'s [STAGE] board. Deliver: Board meeting agenda (monthly/quarterly): 1. Review prior meeting action items (5 min) 2. Financial review: KPIs vs plan + commentary (15 min) 3. Strategic topic 1: Deep discussion (20 min) 4. Strategic topic 2: Deep discussion (20 min) 5. Decisions required: Specific votes needed (10 min) 6. Help needed from board: Specific asks (10 min) 7. Action items: Owner + deadline (5 min) + Board package format (what to prepare and how far in advance)

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [STAGE] Seed/Series A/Series B

■ **Tip:** Send board materials 48 hours in advance. Boards that are prepared in advance have strategic conversations. Boards that review materials in the meeting have operational conversations.

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Prompt #39

Strategic Advisory Board Building

Build a strategic advisory board for [STARTUP] that adds real value.

You are a startup ecosystem connector. Build a strategic advisory board for [STARTUP] that adds real value. Deliver: 1. Advisory board composition: What 5 types of advisors do you need? 2. Ideal advisor profile for each type (specific, not generic) 3. Advisor outreach message templates (3 versions: warm intro / cold / peer referral) 4. Advisor agreement terms (equity 0.1-0.5%, vesting, expectations) 5. How to make advisors actually help you (the cadence and asks that get responses) 6. Red flags in advisors to avoid

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup

■ **Tip:** The best advisors are domain-specific, willing to make introductions, and have been through what you're facing now. Logos matter less than access.

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Prompt #40

Post-Investment 90-Day Plan

Write the post-investment 90-day operating plan for [STARTUP] after cl

You are a venture-backed founder. Write the post-investment 90-day operating plan for [STARTUP] after closing [FUNDING AMOUNT]. Deliver: Month 1 – Foundation: • Key hires to make immediately • Investor onboarding and communication setup • Systems and processes to establish Month 2 – Execution: • Product milestones to hit • Customer acquisition targets • Team building and culture work Month 3 – Proof: • Metrics to show to the board • Next milestone to target • Narrative to develop for future raise Include: How to work with your new investors (what they want from you monthly)

Placeholders: [STARTUP] Your startup [FUNDING AMOUNT] Amount raised

■ **Tip:** The 90 days after closing are the most important 90 days of your startup's life. Move fast — the window of investor goodwill is short.

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